

FOUNDER'S BLUEPRINT 2026

FocusFlow

AI-Powered Productivity & Study Planner

Full-Stack Web App

Claude API Powered

SaaS / Freemium

Students + Corporate

16-Week Build

16

WEEKS TO LAUNCH

7

CORE AI FEATURES

£7.99

PRO / MONTH

NAVIGATE THE PLAN

What's Inside

A complete founder's blueprint — from problem to profit.

01	Executive Summary	11	16-Week Execution Plan
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09	How Users Access FocusFlow	19	Launch Strategy
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SECTION 01

Executive Summary

The 60-second pitch for FocusFlow.



What is FocusFlow?

FocusFlow is a category-defining AI productivity web app that combines task management, AI goal planning, document intelligence, focus tracking, and weekly coaching into a single seamless experience — built for students and corporate professionals.



The Problem

People have goals but no intelligent system to break them down, track progress, and adapt in real-time.



The Solution

An all-in-one AI planner that turns big ambitions into daily actions, keeps users focused, and coaches them weekly.



The Opportunity

\$102B productivity app market. No single product combines AI coaching + study tools + focus timer today.

16 Wks

BUILD TIMELINE

£7.99

PRO MONTHLY

~\$20/mo

DEV RUNNING COST

Aug 2026

TARGET LAUNCH

SECTION 02

The Problem

Why existing tools fail students and professionals.

FOR STUDENTS

**Goal Paralysis**

No system to convert "pass my finals" into today's actions.

**Document Overload**

200-page textbooks with no efficient way to extract key info.

**No Progress Insight**

Zero visibility into actual study hours and consistency.

FOR CORPORATE WORKERS

**Vague OKRs**

Quarterly targets never translate into concrete daily work.

**Too Many Tools**

Notion + Todoist + Toggl + Slack — no single source of truth.

**No AI Coaching**

No weekly retrospective to course-correct before it's too late.

SECTION 03

The Solution

One app that replaces five — powered by AI.

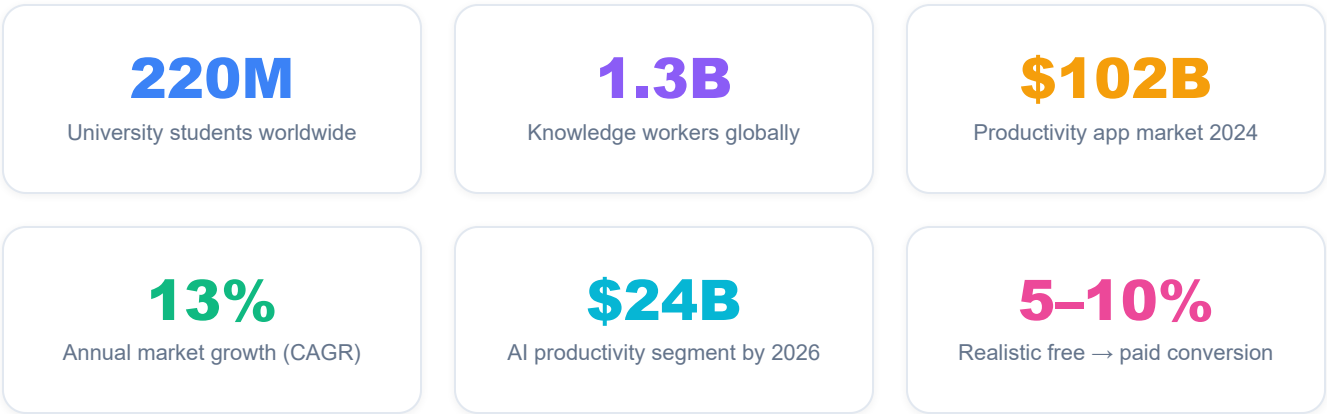
**FocusFlow's Unique Positioning**

No competitor combines AI goal breakdown + document summarisation + Pomodoro focus tracking + weekly AI coaching in a single product. That gap is FocusFlow's moat.

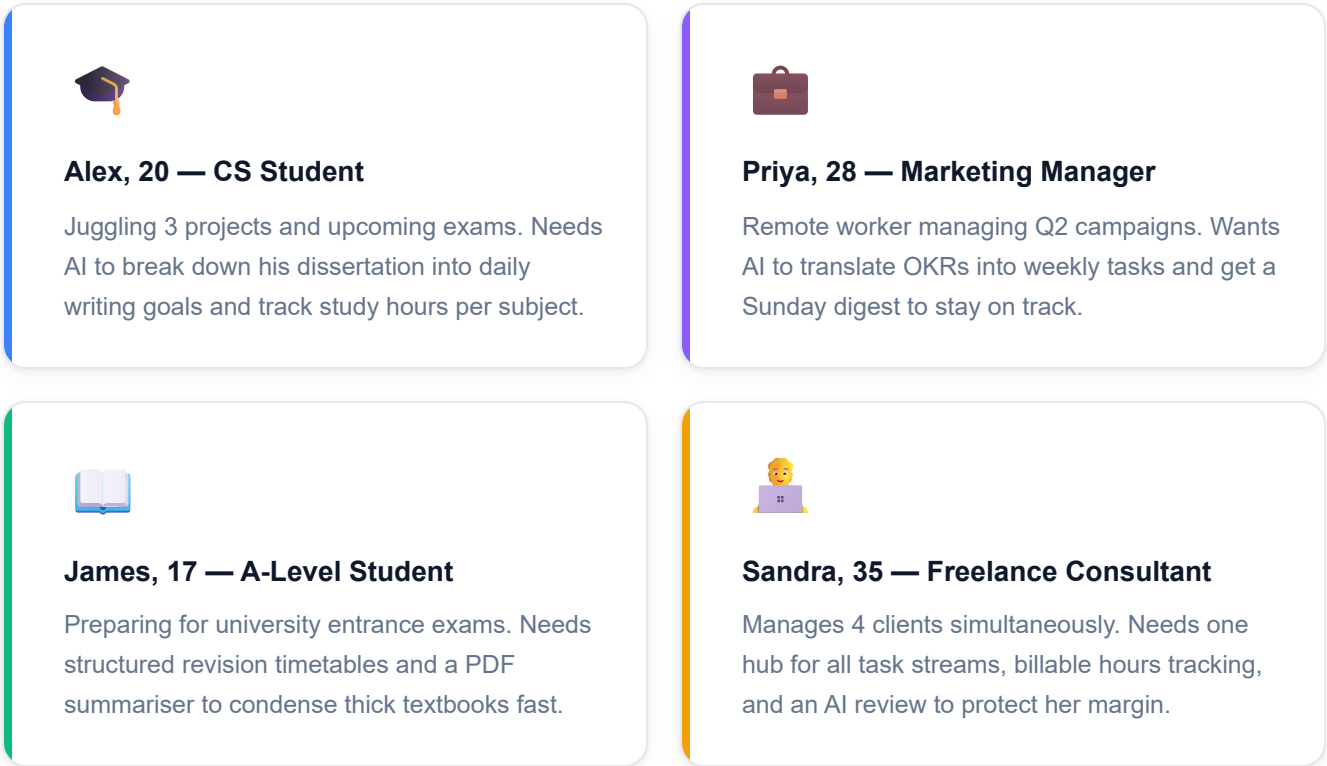
SECTION 04

Target Users & Market Opportunity

Two massive segments. One unified product.



USER PERSONAS



SECTION 05

Core Features — Detailed Specification

Seven AI-powered modules. One seamless experience.



AUTH

User Authentication

Secure JWT-based register/login/logout with bcrypt hashing, refresh tokens, password reset via email, and optional Google OAuth 2.0.

- › JWT access token (15 min) + refresh token (7 days)
- › httpOnly cookie storage — XSS protected
- › Google OAuth sign-in for frictionless onboarding
- › SendGrid password reset emails



TASKS

Task Manager

Full CRUD tasks with priorities, categories, due dates, sub-tasks, recurring tasks, and a drag-and-drop Kanban board.

- › Kanban board (To-Do / In-Progress / Done)
- › Priority tags: High · Medium · Low
- › Category filters: Work · Study · Personal
- › Bulk actions, sub-tasks, recurring tasks



AI

AI Goal Breakdown

Type any big goal — AI returns phase overview, weekly milestones, and daily action steps, automatically saved as tasks.

- › Claude Sonnet 4.6 with chain-of-thought prompt engineering
- › Accepts deadline + context for personalisation

- › One-click: accept, edit, or regenerate any step
- › Rate-limited per tier (3/month free · unlimited Pro)



AI

Document Summariser & Flashcard Generator

Upload PDF or paste text. AI returns executive summary, key bullets, and Q&A flashcards — with study mode and Anki export.

- › LangChain PDF loader + text splitter
- › 300-word summary + 5–10 key points + flashcards
- › Flip-card study mode built in
- › Export to PDF summary or Anki deck (.apkg)



FOCUS

Pomodoro Focus Timer

Evidence-backed 25/5 focus cycles with automatic session logging, productivity streaks, and desktop notifications.

- › Link each session to a specific task
- › Streak counter — consecutive days with ≥ 1 Pomodoro
- › Customisable intervals (Pro feature)
- › All sessions feed into the Analytics Dashboard



ANALYTICS

Analytics Dashboard + Weekly AI Digest

Interactive charts showing productivity trends. Every Sunday, AI generates a personalised coaching report with 3 specific improvements for next week.

- › GitHub-style focus hours heatmap
- › Category distribution pie chart
- › Weekly completion bar chart
- › AI Digest: delivered in-app + email every Sunday

SECTION 06

Technology Stack

Production-grade tools chosen for speed, scalability, and developer experience.

LAYER	TECHNOLOGY	PURPOSE
FRONTEND	React 18 + TypeScript	Component UI with strict typing and hooks
FRONTEND	Tailwind CSS + shadcn/ui	Rapid, consistent, accessible styling system
FRONTEND	Zustand + React Query	Global state + server state caching
FRONTEND	Recharts	Analytics charts and data visualisation
BACKEND	Node.js + Express.js	Stateless REST API with versioned routes
BACKEND	JWT + bcrypt	Authentication and password security
BACKEND	Multer + node-cron	File uploads + scheduled jobs (Weekly Digest)
DATABASE	PostgreSQL + Prisma ORM	Relational DB with type-safe queries
DATABASE	Supabase (managed)	Free-tier hosted PostgreSQL
AI LAYER	Anthropic Claude API	Goal breakdown, summarisation, weekly digest (Sonnet 4.6 + Haiku 4.5)
AI LAYER	LangChain.js	Document loading, chunking, LLM chains
INFRA	Docker + Render	Containerised local dev + free-tier production
INFRA	Cloudinary / AWS S3	PDF and file storage with signed URLs
INFRA	GitHub Actions	CI/CD: test → build → deploy pipeline
TESTING	Jest + Supertest	Backend unit and integration tests

LAYER	TECHNOLOGY	PURPOSE
TESTING	Vitest + RTL	Frontend component tests
BILLING	Stripe	Pro subscriptions + team plan billing
EMAIL	SendGrid	Transactional emails + weekly digest delivery



Architecture: 3-Tier Design

Client (React PWA) → API Server (Express on Render) → PostgreSQL (Supabase) + Claude API + S3. All layers are independently deployable and horizontally scalable.

CLAUDE API MODEL ROUTING STRATEGY

FEATURE	MODEL	WHY
AI Goal Breakdown	claude-sonnet-4-6	Deep reasoning + strict structured JSON output
Document Summariser	claude-sonnet-4-6	200K token context — handles full textbooks without chunking
Flashcard Generation	claude-haiku-4-5	Fast & cheap — simple Q&A format, high volume
Weekly AI Digest	claude-sonnet-4-6	Personalised coaching quality matters here
Task suggestions / tips	claude-haiku-4-5	Low complexity, keeps API costs minimal

SECTION 07

System Architecture



SECTION 08–09

Platform & Access Decision

✓ **Build as PWA Web App (MVP)**

- › Works on every device — no install required
- › No App Store approval delays
- › Installable to home screen like a native app
- › Google-indexable for organic SEO
- › One codebase — faster to ship
- › Near-zero distribution cost

📱 **React Native App (Post-MVP)**

- › Once 1,000+ active web users
- › Reuse same Express API layer
- › iOS App Store + Google Play presence
- › Better offline & native hardware access
- › Estimated: Month 11 of roadmap

HOW USERS ACCESS FOCUSFLOW

Browser

Visit focusflow.app in any browser. Full functionality, zero install.

Installed PWA

Add to home screen on iOS/Android or desktop Chrome. Launches standalone.

Email Digest

Weekly AI coaching report delivered to your inbox every Sunday.

SECTION 10

Everything You Need to Build FocusFlow

Skills, tools, accounts, and costs — all in one place.

SKILLS REQUIRED

1

JavaScript / TypeScript
Intermediate to advanced level

2

React + Node.js + Express
Full-stack fundamentals

3

SQL + ORM (Prisma)
Basic database design

4

Prompt Engineering
Learn as you build — documented in this plan

5

Git + CLI Basics
Version control and terminal usage

TOOLS YOU ALREADY HAVE ✓

>

VS Code ✓

>

Docker Desktop ✓

>

Postman ✓

>

Windows 11 ✓

>

Python 3.14 ✓

MONTHLY COST BREAKDOWN

Render (hosting)	£0
Supabase (PostgreSQL)	£0
SendGrid (email)	£0
Cloudinary (storage)	£0
Anthropic Claude API (dev usage)	~£15
TOTAL	~£15/month

SECTION 11

16-Week Step-by-Step Execution Plan

8 clear phases. One feature shipped per phase.



PHASE 1

Foundation & Project Setup

Weeks 1–2

Monorepo structure · ESLint + Prettier + TypeScript · PostgreSQL + Prisma schema · Docker Compose · GitHub repo + CI skeleton



PHASE 2

Authentication System

Weeks 3–4

Register / Login / Logout API · JWT + refresh tokens · Password reset flow · React auth screens · Protected route HOC



PHASE 3

Task Manager

Weeks 5–6

Full CRUD API · Kanban drag-and-drop board · List view with filters · Sub-tasks + recurring tasks · Integration tests



PHASE 4

AI Goal Breakdown

Weeks 7–8

Anthropic Claude API integration · Prompt engineering module · Goal input form · AI response → task creation · Rate limiting per tier



PHASE 5

Document Summariser

Weeks 9–10

Multer file upload endpoint · LangChain PDF loader · Summary + flashcard prompts · Study mode UI · PDF/Anki export

PHASE 6

Pomodoro Timer + Analytics Dashboard

Weeks 11–12

Timer component · Session logging API · Streak logic · Analytics aggregation endpoints · Recharts dashboard

PHASE 7

Weekly AI Digest

Weeks 13–14

node-cron Sunday job · Digest data query + AI prompt · SendGrid email template · In-app notification badge · Digest history page

PHASE 8

Polish, Testing & Launch

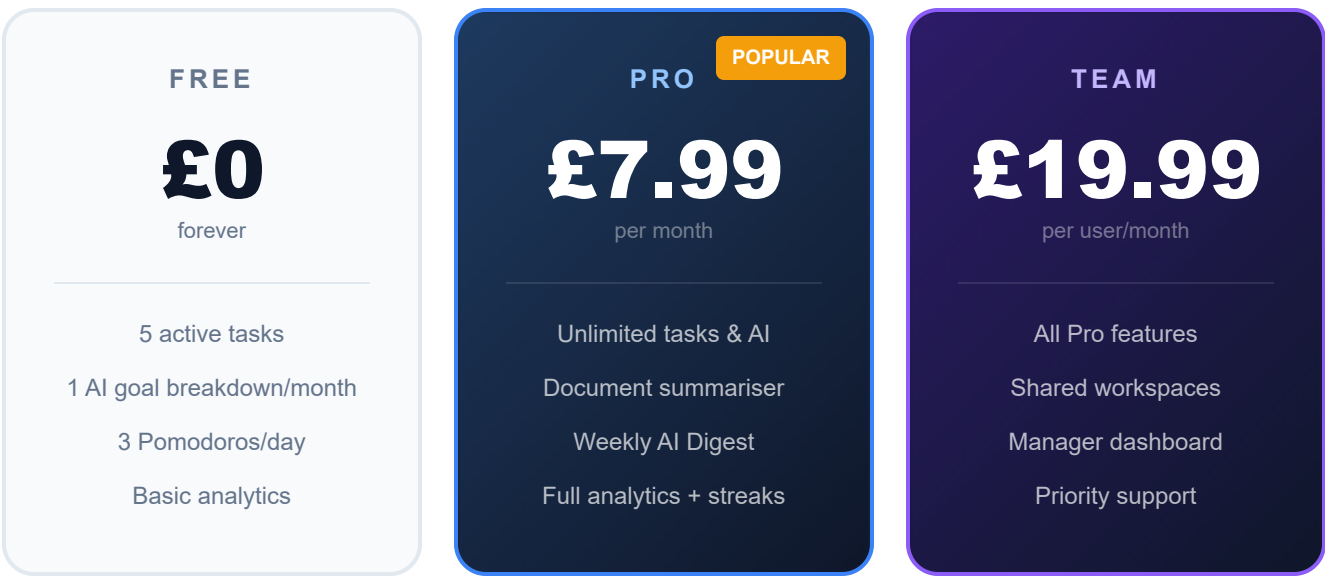
Weeks 15–16

Full test coverage (Jest + Vitest) · Code splitting + performance · Render production deploy · Stripe billing · Product Hunt launch

SECTION 12

Revenue Model & Pricing

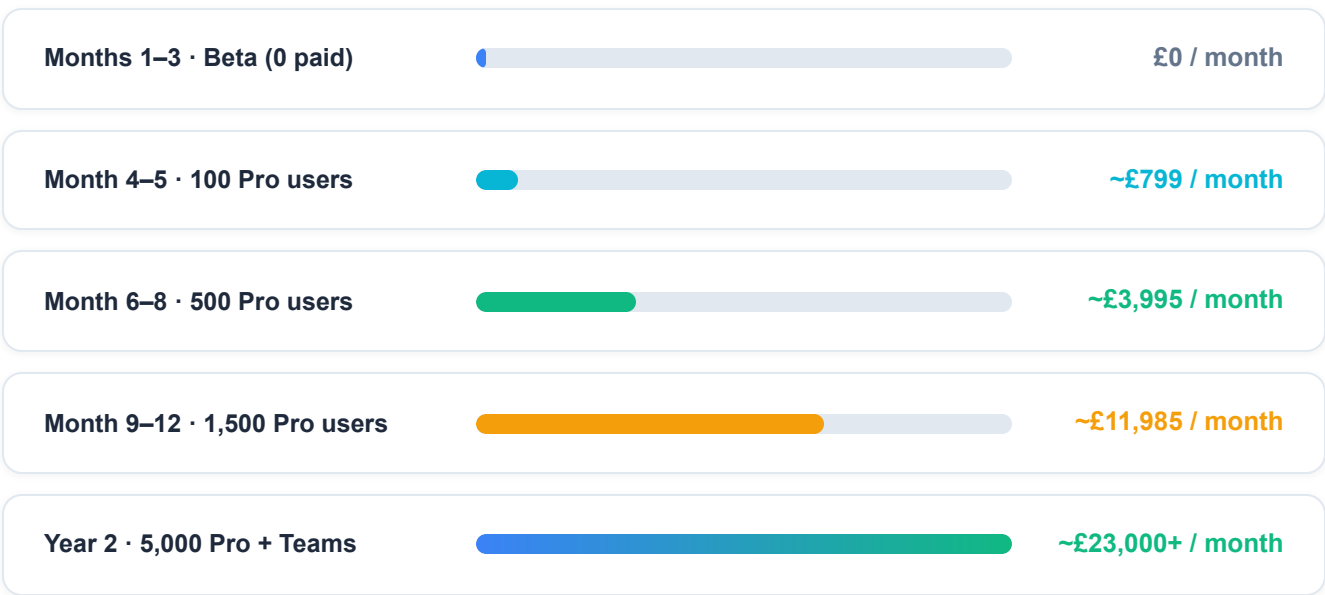
Freemium entry, Pro conversion, institutional licensing.



SECTION 13

Founder Earnings Forecast

Conservative projections based on 5% free→paid conversion.





Additional Revenue Streams

University licensing (£500–£2,000/yr per institution) · Corporate white-label partnerships ·
Affiliate/referral commission on Pro upgrades

SECTION 14

Benefits to Students



Instant Study Plans

Type a goal, get a day-by-day revision plan in seconds. No more staring at a blank calendar.



200-Page PDFs in 60 Seconds

The summariser turns any textbook into a concise summary + flashcards instantly.



Gamified Consistency

Pomodoro streaks make studying feel like a game. Same psychology as Duolingo.



Real Study Hour Data

See exactly how many hours you studied per subject — no more guessing.



Free AI Coaching Every Week

The Weekly Digest is like having a personal tutor review your week — for free.



Less Exam Stress

Organised plans + small daily steps dramatically reduce exam-season anxiety.

SECTION 15 · CORPORATE WORKERS



OKRs → Daily Tasks

AI converts vague quarterly goals into concrete, actionable daily work.



Deep Work Evidence

Hard data on focus hours per week — great for WFH accountability.



One Hub for Everything

Replace 5 separate tools with one login and one dashboard.



Private Weekly Retrospective

AI flags drift before it becomes a crisis — every Sunday, automatically.



Instant Document Intelligence

Upload a 40-page board report — get an executive summary in seconds.



Priority Clarity Always

High/Medium/Low tags + AI sorting answer "what do I do right now?"



Section 16 · Societal Benefits

FocusFlow **democratises AI coaching** for students who can't afford tutors · **reduces cognitive overload** and burnout in an always-on world · **supports neurodivergent users** (ADHD, dyslexia) with structured step-by-step plans · **reduces educational inequality** by giving every student equal access to intelligent academic planning.

SECTION 17

Competitive Landscape

PRODUCT	AI GOALS	DOC SUMMARY	POMODORO	WEEKLY DIGEST	STUDENT FOCUS
Notion	X	X	X	X	X
Todoist	X	X	X	X	X
Motion	✓	X	X	X	X
MyStudyLife	X	X	X	X	✓
Forest	X	X	✓	X	X
FocusFlow ✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

SECTION 18

Risk Analysis & Mitigation

Claude API Cost Spiral

HighMedium Impact

Cache responses, rate-limit by tier, use claude-haiku-4-5 for simple tasks and claude-sonnet-4-6 only for complex AI features.

Low Free→Paid Conversion

Medium

14-day Pro trial, in-app upgrade nudges at natural friction points.

Solo Dev Burnout

Medium

Strict one-feature-per-phase discipline. Avoid scope creep. Follow the 16-week plan.

Big Tech Copies Feature

Low

Community loyalty + niche focus are the moat. Move fast and build the brand.

Data Privacy Concerns

Medium

GDPR compliance, clear privacy policy, encrypted storage, no data resale ever.

Low Organic Discovery

Medium

SEO-optimised landing page + student communities (Reddit, Discord, TikTok).

SECTION 19

Launch Strategy

PRE-LAUNCH (WEEKS 13–16)

1

Landing Page + Waitlist
Email capture with Mailchimp · Build anticipation

2

Build in Public
Weekly progress posts on Twitter/X + LinkedIn

3

Student Communities
Reddit (r/GetStudying), Discord, student unions

4

Demo Video
2-min video on TikTok, YouTube Shorts, Instagram Reels

LAUNCH WEEK

5

Product Hunt
Post Tuesday 12:01 AM PST — maximise votes

6

Waitlist Email
Personal founder note to every subscriber

7

Indie Hackers Story
"I built an AI planner in 16 weeks — here's how"

8

First 100 Offer
Lifetime 50% off Pro for the first 100 sign-ups

SECTION 20

12-Month Growth Roadmap

Months 1–4	MVP Build	All 7 features built, internal testing, private beta with 20 users
Month 5	Public Beta	Product Hunt, waitlist emails, free tier open to all
Month 6	Pro Launch	Stripe billing live · Target: 100 paying users
Months 7–8	Polish	Performance tuning, PWA mobile experience, user-requested features

Month 9	Team Plan	Workspace sharing, manager dashboard, bulk invite
Month 10	University	First institutional licensing deal pitched and closed
Month 11	Mobile App	React Native iOS + Android app submitted to app stores
Month 12	Scale	1,000 Pro users · Sustainable MRR · Consider first hire

CALL TO ACTION

**Start Week 1 today.
Build the repo. Ship the auth. The rest
follows.**

The market is waiting. The plan is complete. The window is open.

16 Weeks

7 Features

1 Founder

August 2026